into State production. Taking control of the state and production, the proletariats, destroy all class differences and class antagonisms, and finally resulting in the 'Withering Away of the State'.

Assessment

In 1852, ***Marx*** summarized his contributions into three major sections:

a. Classes (proletariat and bourgeoisie) are not a permanent features of a society

b. Class struggle leads to 'dictatorship of the proletariat', resulting in workers taking control of production

c. 'Dictatorship of the proletariat' would lead to classless society and with the differences vanishing from the society, the state eventually withers away.

The impact that Marxism had on humanity can only be compared to the influence religion had on mankind. Nearly half of the world population was influenced by Marxist ideology. While, ***Marx*** himself would have not followed everything he wrote, his writings did influence leaders like Lenin, Stalin, Mao and others who used Marxist theories in order to bring about change in countries like Russia, China, Cuba, Vietnam, etc. In the present era most of the erstwhile communist countries have become democratic in nature. However, the society continues to witness class differences and it is increasing every year. Hence, so long there are capitalists and exploitation in the society, ***Marx***'s ideas can never be ignored or forgotten.



Contemporary debates on Marxism focus on relative importance of its basic tenets and identification of some new forms of dominations and conflicts emerging in the present day society. These debates led to the emergency of Neo-Marxism.

Glossary



Bourgeoisie: The capitalist class who own most of society's wealth and means of production.

Classless Society: The ultimate condition of social organization, expected to occur when true communism.

Dialectic: An enquiry into metaphysical contradictions and their solutions.

Dictatorship of the Proletariat: In Marxism, rule by the proletariat—the economic and social class consisting of industrial workers who derive income solely from their labour—during the transitional phase between the abolition of capitalism and the establishment of communism.

Enlightenment: A European intellectual movement of the late 17th and 18th centuries emphasizing reason and individualism rather than tradition.

General Will: In political theory, a collectively held will that aims at the common good or common interest.

Glorious Revolution: The events of 1688–89 that resulted in the deposition of

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